Embassy and the Indian High Commission in Dhaka, the Bangladeshi capital.[91] Acting on information stemming from these initial arrests, the Bangladeshi and Indian police quickly detained additional suspects, including several more Lashkar members as well as other Pakistani militants.[92] By summer 2010, they had arrested over a dozen Lashkar operatives, including four Pakistanis and six Indians. Several of these men had been in Bangladesh for years, building Lashkar's network there, and they told authorities that many more operatives were still in the country. Police allege that some of the suspects confessed to having been taken to Pakistan for training and said that ISI agents helped to prepare their passports, though when this occurred is unclear.[93] Most were in Bangladesh to organize attacks against India, which raises questions about whether the attack in Dhaka was a sanctioned Lashkar operation.

Western and Bangladeshi officials suggested these developments came amidst what they viewed as an expansion of Lashkar activity in Bangladesh and indications the group was considering opening up an active front there.[94] However, according to another Western intelligence analyst who tracks the group and is familiar with the case, evidence suggests a faction within the group or loosely connected to it may have been responsible for the attempted attacks.[95] Police in Bangladesh said the arrests were made based on information gained from Headley and Indian intelligence reportedly intercepted phone conversations linking those detained to Abdur Rehman Syed, who is believed to have provided money as well as issued the directive to launch the attack.[96] It is possible Abdul Rehman was working with Lashkar in Pakistan to execute the operation, but equally plausible that he leveraged his connections to the group's network for an unsanctioned attack. As mentioned above, Syed controlled his own unit in Karachi and built up networks in Bangladesh and Nepal while with Lashkar. He took this 'Lashkar infrastructure' with him when he floated his own outfit.[97] Whether sanctioned or unsanctioned, the episode provided additional evidence of four trends that characterized Lashkar post-Mumbai: the expansion of its jihad; the versatile and protean nature of its networks; the possibility that personal connections might enable individuals or factions to use these networks for freelance operations; and, finally, the integration of Indian targets with the jihad against America and its allies.